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Sprint Review and Retrospective – Summary

Sprint Review

The first sprint ran from the Sprint Planning on the 27th of April until the Sprint Review on the 10th of May. Our goals for the sprint were formulated, as recommended by our group advisor Ahmad, relatively broadly. His word of advice was that during and after the first sprint, the app would quite probably not show much improvement or change in relation to how much work we put in, but the underlying framework would facilitate the development process in the coming sprints greatly.

This prediction proved quite accurate. Many of the distributed tasks were prerequisites for later tasks and user stories, such as getting access to sensor data, interacting with Android's internal storage, sending notifications, and providing an interactable app framework onto which functionality can later be built. For many of these, it was necessary to communicate with the Android System and Android Studio on varying levels of depth and a decent chunk of time was spent on researching how these features can best be implemented. While this time was not spent on measurable progress, we calculated with this in mind, distributed relatively high-level tasks and are sure that the knowledge gained here will come in handy later on in the project.

The tasks which we distributed at the start of the sprint were all achieved. We did plan with a solid time buffer and could probably have implemented a few more features and maybe even made additional tangible progress before the next sprint, but as described, we used the time well anyway.

Sprint Retrospective

Before the sprint, we agreed, partially as a result of the first task in the previous group assignment, on a few basic guidelines for our group work. This included two weekly meetings, online on Mondays and at the university on Thursdays, a clear distribution of work as mentioned before and the creation of a discord server for micro-communication, announcement and similar messaging. We were aware that our communication would be limited in the beginning, as everyone needs to first immerse themselves in their area of specialty before they can start interacting and sharing. Thus, apart from the meetings, which worked quite well for syncing progress and were all attended by all group members except one which fell on a public holiday, everyone worked in relative isolation.

While this may also just be because not much help was needed and the tasks were clear and decision-free, we all agreed in the sprint retrospective that we want more communication. We want to combine an increase of work in pairs or groups with a bit of a shift in our usage

of GitHub. The branching system served us well for the most part, as everyone was able to implement their features free of interference and conflicts, but the large delay between starting a task and merging it into the main branch prevented effective collaboration and resulted in too much isolation. Therefore, we concurred that we need to commit more frequently and use branches for somewhat smaller parts of features.

Moving away from the few negative aspects, our group atmosphere was stellar. We were very effective in our meetings, agreed quite quickly on important decisions and did not struggle with keeping up with the project's progress. Everyone seemed very eager to complete their tasks and contributed to our work. The climate was so good, in fact, that during the sprint retrospective, we agreed that sometimes a bit more focus and seriousness is needed during the meetings because we had too much fun joking around with each other when we could have been more effective and disciplined.

All in all, the first sprint was a positive experience. We planned well, set systems in place which will facilitate future work and executed on that planning effectively. We are looking forward to continue working on the second sprint with slight adjustments to our workflow and continuing enthusiasm.